

Problem 3. Pular Answers and Explanation (1/2)

Problem 3. Pular

3.1	a Teachers have healed the students.	3.2	a Deemuuru ndun wañee. [2]
	b The holes have been washed.		b Remooɓe ñaama kobokobooje den. [3]
	c The monkeys have sat.		c Saakuuji luboo. [2]
	d The chef washes the sweet potato.		d Gookiiru ndun danndi ɓoheere nden. [3]
			e Danndoowo on defa maafe on. [3]

Q 3.1. Max 8 points. 1pt if all NPs are correct; 1pt if VP is correct. Do not penalise past for perfect. Allow any reasonable translation of *heal*, e.g. *cure*, *look after*.

Q 3.2. Max 13. 1pt for each NP; 1pt for each verb. Do not penalise **b, d, n** for **ɓ, ɗ, ñ**.

Q 3.3. Max 17. 2pts for syntax; 6pts for verbs; 9pts for nouns.

Problem 3. Pular Answers and Explanation (2/2)

Explanation

- Word order is SVO, with definite articles following nouns.
- Verbs conjugate as follows, where middle = intransitive/reflexive:

	Active	Middle	Passive
Simple/imperfective	-a	-oo	-ee
Perfect	-i	-ii	-aa

- Nouns decline as follows, with the definite article (in brackets).

	Singular	Plural
Human	-wo (on)	-be (ben)
Animal	-ru (ndun)	-ji (dīn)
Fruit/Vegetable	-re (nden)	-je (den)
Other	-Ø (on)	-ji (dīn)

- Human nouns can be derived from verbs by suffixing **-o(o)**
- Vowels are doubled before suffixes – alternatively, the Other-Plural suffix is **-Vji**.

Commentary

Most verbs have their voice lexically determined, e.g., active verbs have no passive equivalent. Equally, many verbs conjugate according to a voice that is difficult to understand as an English speaker.

The actual noun class system of Pular is far more complex. An extract is presented below, although other classes exist.

Article	Ending	Usage
on	o / Ø	humans; borrowings
ben	be	human plurals
den	e	other plurals
dīn	i	
nden	e	fruits/vegetables; locations; abstract nouns; measures of time; etc.
ndin	i	attributes; food
ndun	u	some animals; body parts
ngon	o	body parts; circular things
kin	i	trees; medicine; sharp objects
ngin	ii	insects; pejoratives

Sources:

[Pular Resources \(ibamba.net\)](http://ibamba.net)

TEACHING GRAMMAR OF PULAR, Barrie Evans

[Dictionnaire Pular - Votre dictionnaire peul sur la Toile \(webonary.org\)](http://webonary.org)